

Group DIS1

Project Initiation Request

EEA Infrastructure Architecture Strategy

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Commission européenne, B-1049 Bruxelles / Europese Commissie, B-1049 Brussel - Belgium.

Telephone: (32-2) 299 11 11.

Office: 05/45. Telephone: direct line (32-2) 2999659.

Commission européenne, L-2920 Luxembourg. Telephone: (352) 43 01-1.

Project Title:	EEA Infrastructure Architecture Strategy		
Initiator:	Giorgos Ksouris, Nils Hettich	Group:	DIS1
Project Owner (PO):	Karl Hamilton	Solution Provider (SP):	Giorgos Ksouris, HoG DIS1
Type of Delivery:	☐ In-house ☒ Outsourced ☐ Mix ☐ Not-known	Target Delivery Date:	31 October 2024
Estimated budget:	Total core budget: Consultancy services: approx. 100k EUR Staff effort in FTE: - DIS1: PM: approx. 0.2 FTE over the project duration - Other EEA staff involved in the project, e.g. as interviewees and to provide input, approx. 40 hours in total Other costs: - No extra costs foreseen		
Context/ Situation (Business Need/ Problem / Opportunity)			
The growing complexity of information systems and the large amount of legacy infrastructure and applications presents a significant obstacle for the EEA, hindering innovation, compromising system dependability, and binding resources. The uncontrolled growth of system complexity and new emerging technologies (e.g. AI) can be overcome by designing the right architecture, development concepts, system structures and mechanisms. For that it is crucial to establish a robust, future-proof overall IT architecture, alongside innovative development concepts, system structures, and mechanisms. These elements form the core of a 'reference ICT infrastructure architecture', serving as the structural framework for the creation of EEAs IT service catalogue. Such an architecture outlines the agency's system design principles, merging the 'what' with the 'how-to', and integrates essential solution patterns that cater to the needs of all EEA stakeholders effectively. This project is a follow-up on the recent Deloitte study “Fit for Purpose – Digital and Data Capabilities, Current state assessment”, in particular on the recommended initiative presented as 4.1 in the report: Technical Platform Architecture.			

EEA's strategic goal / Legal basis
EEA and Eionet have established a joint long-term strategy for 2021-2030, titled "Delivering data and knowledge to achieve Europe's environment and climate ambitions." This strategy outlines five strategic objectives (SOs) up to 2030, which are all dependent on a suitable and future-proof IT infrastructure, in particular Strategic objective 1: <i>Providing timely input to solutions for sustainability challenges</i> and strategic objective 4: <i>Making full use of the potential of data, technology and digitalisation</i> .
Outcomes / Benefits (high level)
The practical outcomes of the project are: • Assessment of current state architecture including local data centre and cloud services. A detailed 'As-Is' inventory report of current services and infrastructures, • A business needs analysis report that maps the current state against future requirements, complemented by a gap analysis identifying missing services, required technologies, and human and financial resources. The future architecture must accommodate AI tools and large data volumes. • Documentation of stakeholder interviews and workshops, highlighting discussions on service provision, IT Steering Committee insights, and stakeholder engagement outcomes. • An ICT infrastructure architecture strategy document that outlines the future architecture and includes cybersecurity, governance, risk and compliance aspects. • A roadmap and a transition plan for the implementation of the future infrastructure architecture, detailing deliverables, alignment with business needs and priorities, key performance indicators and resource allocation.
Impact (high level)
From the outcomes and deliverables of this project, one of the immediate tangible impacts will be a better clarity on ICT investment priorities in the future, giving decision makers in DIS and the SMT a clear indication where and how much resources need to be invested in the coming years to achieve the desired "to-be" architecture. It will also have an impact as a key input for the update and revision of the overall EEA IT strategy and EEA data strategy.
Success Criteria
• All identified relevant stakeholders have been involved and contributed to the needs analysis. • The project is completed within the allocated timeframe and within approved budget, in order to inform any follow up activities and provide input into e.g. the EEA IT strategy • General agreement and acceptance on the project deliverables and drawn conclusions by DIS management

The delivered <i>Implementation Roadmap and action plan</i> are realistic and sufficiently concrete to be used for the implementation of the roadmap as the next step	
Assumptions (<i>high level</i>)	
- The EEA project team as well as all stakeholders will dedicate the necessary time, effort, and commitment to ensure the successful completion of the project within the scheduled timeframe. - The contractor will visit EEA site as required and agreed upon, with the duration depending on the size and complexity of the activities. - The EEA project team will organise the events, mobilising interviewees and ensuring their participation in workshops and interviews.	
Constraints (<i>high level</i>)	
- Existing documentation will not always be sufficient for the "As-Is" analysis, requiring more in-depth interviews and follow-ups with the relevant stakeholders from DIS groups - Compliance with EEA's rules and regulations concerning ICT and the management of these services. - Deliverables must be completed within the timeframe agreed upon in the project plan. - Availability of senior management stakeholders for interviews - The ICT infrastructure architecture strategy document must be completed no later than 6 months from the kick-off, barring any significant delays in stakeholder interviews.	
Risks (<i>high level</i>)	
- Lack of documentation of the entire current IT infrastructure could lead to delays, additional costs to gather information by the consultants. - Difficulty to find availability of (senior) management for interviews and workshops could lead to delays or missing critical input for the business requirements. - Stakeholders might not return with requested data in time (surveys, templates, questionnaires), leading to delays or an incomplete picture. - Findings and conclusions of the exercise might not suit all stakeholders, as it will likely restrict the current "freedom" in choosing platforms and applications due to the lack of an enforced infrastructure strategy	
EEA risks level:	While the overall IT infrastructure affects EEA, Eionet and beyond, due to the nature of this exercise as a study/report, the risk level of this project can be seen as low overall.